convergence
foundation

Position

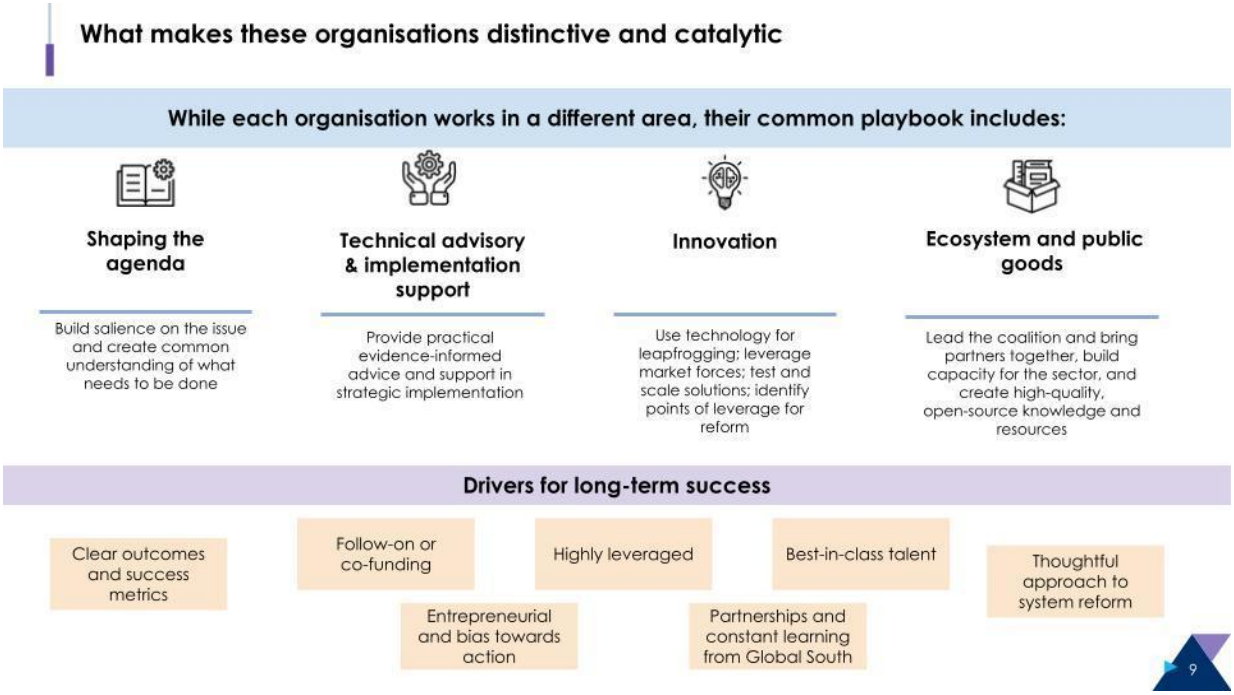
Program Associate (PA)

About The Convergence Foundation

Ashish Dhawan is one of India's leading philanthropists. He founded and ran one of India's first private equity funds, ChrysCapital, and in the last decade has helped build successful institutions (for e.g., Ashoka University) and strategic foundations (for e.g., Central Square Foundation, which works on school education reform). More recently, these include organisations that are working on building a better understanding between India and East Asia, improving the performance of the public sector, solving the air pollution crisis, and improving the pipeline of leadership and talent in the social sector.

We are now setting up **The Convergence Foundation** to do this in an institutionalized manner - identify critical voids in the social sector and build 20 strong, long-lasting organisations to solve complex problems by 2035.

While each organisation works in a different area, their common playbook includes:



convergence
foundation

Our Current Portfolio[1]

- Ashoka University (est. 2010)
- Central Square Foundation (est. 2012)
- Air Pollution Action Group (est. 2019)
- Asian Century Foundation (est. 2019)
- India Leaders for Social Sector (est. 2017)
- Centre for Effective Governance of Indian States (est. 2019)
- Accelerate Indian Philanthropy (est. 2021)
- Foundation for Advancing Science and Technology (est. 2021)

- Foundation for Economic Development (est. 2022)
- WE Rise (placeholder name for Foundation for Advancement of Women, est. 2022)
- ChangeINKK (est. 2022)

Recruitment

While this recruitment drive is being led by The Convergence Foundation, you may be placed at any of the below mentioned portfolio organisations. In case you have a preference for one of these organisations, please make it clear during the application process.

1. **Central Square Foundation:** Focuses on school education reform, with the goal of reducing learning poverty in India to 20% so every child can read and do basic maths. The major priority is improving foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN), with additional work streams in low-income private schools and EdTech.
2. **Asian Century Foundation:** Previously was the China India Foundation, but has now expanded to other countries in East Asia/the Global South. The goal is to create a knowledge corridor and promote knowledge sharing in key social and development areas between India and other nations in the Global South.
3. **Centre for Effective Governance of Indian States:** Focuses on improving state capacity in India, by working on outcome measurement (data), personnel management, and strategic budgeting. Karthik is the entrepreneur for this organisation, and is a well-renowned economist who brings a lot of expertise in the space.
4. **Accelerate Indian Philanthropy:** Aims to work with HNIs/UHNIs to unlock capital for the social sector. The core of this organisation is to work with philanthropists to encourage them to give more, give sooner, and give better.
5. **Foundation for Advancing Science and Technology:** Aims to liberalise the S&T policy landscape, and increase the scientific temper of the nation by bringing together academia, institutions, the private sector, and the government.
6. **Foundation for Economic Development:** FED aims to facilitate ~20% growth per year in export led, labour-intensive manufacturing in India in the next 10 years, as we believe that it is the best way to achieve fast, broad based growth.

[1] Some of these organisations are a collective effort and have been co-founded along with other philanthropists/sector leaders

7. **WE Rise:** WE Rise aims to be India's leading organisation for understanding and mitigating barriers to women empowerment by working with key stakeholders across the ecosystem, including the government, to run scalable, high-impact interventions and reform policies to support women empowerment.
8. **ChangeINKK:** Aims to remove the stigma around neurodiversity and learning disabilities, starting with dyslexia. It is committed to working on causes of inclusion of persons with disabilities, gender equality, and the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals. It will be led by Noopur Jhunjhunwala, a parent advocate, who has 20 years of experience working with the government, private sector, and development agencies across policy, implementation, and monitoring and evaluation.

Position Summary

Our organisations are looking to hire exceptional Program Associates to work with the team on building the organisation's overall research, sharing insights and supporting in development, implementation and evaluation of interventions and projects.

This is a great opportunity for those who enjoy working in a start-up environment, enjoy building and scaling organisations, and care deeply about the impact sector. This role includes working with senior stakeholders and engaging with them on strategic projects that have the potential to solve key development challenges.

Key responsibilities

- Work on strategic projects for the organisation and assist other team members in the design and delivery of projects, in collaboration external stakeholders
- Support the leadership team with research, implementation, and organisation-building
- Aid in the creation of knowledge products across areas including engaging in secondary research, speaking with experts and synthesizing data
- Take on diverse operational tasks to ensure organizational success
- Assist the leadership team with creating and maintaining deep engagement with top leaders, funders and experts
- Develop activities and programs as needed, so as to build coalitions and collaborations with the intention to build a high-performing and execution focused organisation in the development sector

Required Qualifications, Skills and Abilities

- Undergraduate degree from a top tier institution; while there is no preference for a particular major or specialization, we expect to see a high degree of intellectual curiosity and sophistication
- 0-2 years of work experience in a challenging/ high growth environment

- Excellent analytical, critical thinking and problem-solving skills
- Solid planning and organizational skills with high attention to detail, accuracy, protocol and deadline
- Excellent writing ability that is clear, concise and analytic in style
- Excellent communication, interpersonal, and stakeholder-facing skills including solid presentation and facilitation skills
- High level of flexibility and responsiveness with the ability to shift priorities quickly and as organizational demands require

Desired Qualities

- High level of discretion in maintaining confidentiality of sensitive materials and issues
- Ability to take initiative and develop solutions quickly and effectively
- Ability to understand and consider organizational culture and change
- Ability to function and interact in a professional level capacity to sustain the mission, culture and best interests of the respective organisations
- Ability to adapt and exhibit confidence in a highly evolving, agile, and fast paced work environment
- Ability to do research and distill important concepts in a structured, concise, yet comprehensive manner
- Broad and strategic mindset, creative aptitude and effective use of independent judgment
- Operating style suited to working in a small-organization setting, where teamwork and resourcefulness are highly valued

Compensation

Remuneration will be competitive with Indian philanthropy pay scales and will depend upon the candidate's experience.

Location

New Delhi, India